energy of Indian youth and awakened in many young people a restless quest for truth. One of his more famous exhortations to young Indians came from his lectures in *Raja Yoga*, in which he memorably said, 'Take up one idea. Make that one idea your life—think of it, dream of it, live on that idea. Let the brain, muscles, nerves, every part of your body, be full of that idea, and just leave every other idea alone. This is the way to success, that is the way great spiritual giants are produced'.

A spiritual giant himself, Vivekananda expressed his mission in disarmingly simple terms: 'What I want to propagate is a religion that will be equally acceptable to all minds; it must be equally philosophic, equally emotional, equally mystic and equally conducive to action'. His own teachings, as well as the work done by the Ramakrishna Math and Mission in the century after his passing, have made Swami Vivekananda a modern day apostle of the ideas that underpin the modern Hindu's conception of the world and of our place in it.

But the fact is that he never considered himself detached from the world; his spirituality was anchored in the world. Swami Vivekananda taught us that a true nationalism that was rooted in both spiritual yearning and a spirit of social service. 'Arise, awake, and stop not till the goal is reached' was his motto, citing a *sloka* (verse) of the *Katha Upanishad*. And that, to my mind, is the great lesson he leaves to those of us in public life: that we must have values, that we must join the quest for attainment of some knowledge of the Divine, for that is ultimately what all spirituality is about, but that spirituality is meaningless if it is not embedded in a genuine concern for the well-being of ordinary people in our country, and a willingness to act on it.

In multiple speeches around the world and in India, Vivekananda continually reiterated a basic message: that the Hindu recognises one supreme spirit that suffuses the universe. He worships the one God while recognising that others see and name Him differently. 'Ekam sat vipra bahudha vadanti': the Truth is One but sages call It by different names.

AFTER THE SWAMI, TOWARDS THE MAHATMA

Two decades after Vivekananda's premature death at the age of thirty-nine, a very different figure, clad not in the saffron or ochre robes of the